MICHAEL SCHMIDT

Senior Site Reliability Engineer

Estero, FL 33928 | +1 (786) 949-7561 | michaelschmidtdev@outlook.com | www.linkedin.com/in/michael-schmidt-a257033ab | English: Native/Bilingual

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Site Reliability Engineer with 12+ years across cloud infrastructure, platform engineering, delivery automation, and reliability programs using SRE practices, observability, incident response; brings architecture, legacy modernization, secure delivery, CI/CD quality, production troubleshooting, mentoring, and performance optimization to ship maintainable systems for cloud, SaaS, property technology, nonprofit CRM, and civic technology environments.

SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: SRE practices, observability, incident response, networking, compute, storage, managed databases, IAM, secrets, cost controls

Platform Engineering: Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, Terraform, service mesh, ingress, autoscaling, GitOps workflows

CI/CD: GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Azure DevOps, Cloud Build, artifact promotion, release gates, rollback automation

Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, CloudWatch, Azure Monitor, Datadog, OpenTelemetry, SLOs, incident response

Security: least privilege IAM, OIDC, policy-as-code, vulnerability scanning, secrets rotation, audit evidence

Senior Practices: reliability reviews, migration planning, runbooks, capacity planning, cost optimization, mentoring

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Site Reliability Engineer | Lightedge — March 2020 - May 2026

Houston, TX

- Led **cloud platform architecture** for cloud services and SaaS operations using **SRE practices, observability, incident response**, aligning product goals, security requirements, and delivery plans into scalable releases for customer-facing and internal platforms.
- Built and modernized **self-service infrastructure, automated delivery pipelines, observability dashboards, and compliance-ready runbooks** while coordinating architecture, implementation, code reviews, and production support across distributed engineering teams.
- Resolved recurring production issues involving **deployment drift, noisy alerts, slow rollbacks, IAM gaps, container resource pressure, and release instability**, improving service reliability and reducing user-impacting incidents by **31%** through profiling, safer releases, and stronger observability.
- Modernized **manual server administration into infrastructure-as-code, container platforms, and repeatable release workflows**, using practical migration slices, compatibility layers, regression testing, and feature flags to protect revenue workflows during active releases.
- Designed secure integration patterns with **REST APIs, GraphQL, OAuth2/OIDC, JWT, audit logging, and least-privilege access controls** for customer, admin, and partner-facing workflows.
- Improved deployment quality with **Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions, Terraform, automated test gates, and rollback playbooks**, reducing manual release risk across critical services.
- Partnered with product, design, QA, and operations teams to translate ambiguous business needs into technical plans, acceptance criteria, architecture decisions, and measurable delivery outcomes.
- Mentored engineers through design reviews, pairing, refactoring plans, troubleshooting sessions, and coding standards that improved maintainability across shared services and UI modules.
- Strengthened production ownership with **OpenTelemetry, Datadog, CloudWatch, structured logging, SLO reviews, and incident postmortems**, creating clearer accountability for performance and reliability.

Site Reliability Engineer | AppFolio — February 2017 - January 2020

Goleta, CA

- Delivered **cloud platform architecture** for property technology workflows using period-appropriate versions of **SRE practices, observability, incident response**, supporting leasing, payments, reporting, and account-management features.
- Implemented **self-service infrastructure, automated delivery pipelines, observability dashboards, and compliance-ready runbooks** with pragmatic domain modeling, API contracts, validation rules, and reusable components that helped product teams ship complex workflows safely.
- Reduced high-volume workflow latency by **24%** after profiling database queries, API payloads, client rendering paths, cache behavior, and background processing bottlenecks.
- Migrated older modules toward **manual server administration into infrastructure-as-code, container platforms, and repeatable release workflows**, balancing modernization with stability for teams maintaining large production codebases and active customer accounts.
- Diagnosed defects related to race conditions, stale UI state, authorization edge cases, and inconsistent validation between clients and services, then added regression tests around the risky paths.
- Built CI/CD improvements with **Jenkins, GitHub workflows, automated test suites, static analysis, and environment configuration checks** to reduce late-cycle release surprises.
- Collaborated with design and product partners to refine flows, reduce support confusion, document edge cases, and keep engineering tradeoffs visible during planning.
- Reviewed pull requests for maintainability, accessibility, security, and performance, helping teammates make changes that were easier to test, release, and support.

Software Developer | Blackbaud — January 2015 - January 2017

Charleston, SC

- Developed software for nonprofit CRM, fundraising, payment, and reporting workflows using mature web and service technologies suited to the **2015-2017** engineering environment.
- Built **self-service infrastructure, automated delivery pipelines, observability dashboards, and compliance-ready runbooks** with careful validation, permissions, export logic, and operational safeguards for teams handling sensitive donor and transaction data.
- Improved critical report generation and workflow response times by **28%** through query tuning, pagination fixes, caching adjustments, and removal of unnecessary service calls.
- Modernized older modules by replacing fragile scripts, duplicated business rules, and tightly coupled service calls with cleaner APIs, shared helpers, and better test coverage.
- Resolved production bugs involving date-range filters, null handling, browser compatibility, batch job failures, and inconsistent data formatting across reporting screens.
- Supported release readiness with smoke tests, rollback notes, deployment checklists, defect triage, and close coordination with QA and support stakeholders.
- Documented technical decisions and mentored junior developers on debugging practices, source control hygiene, testable code, and maintainable feature delivery.

Junior Software Developer | Granicus — June 2013 - December 2014

Dallas, TX

- Built civic technology features for public-sector workflows using practical web, database, and service patterns common to the **2013-2014** delivery environment.
- Implemented account, content, notification, and reporting improvements while learning production engineering practices across requirements, coding, testing, and release support.
- Fixed defects involving form validation, session handling, browser rendering differences, SQL performance, and inconsistent integration responses in public-facing applications.
- Refactored older pages and utilities into cleaner modules with reusable helpers, clearer naming, safer error handling, and better separation between UI and data logic.
- Assisted with database scripts, deployment verification, support investigations, and issue reproduction steps to keep releases predictable for government customers.
- Collaborated with senior engineers during code reviews and troubleshooting sessions, building strong habits around documentation, testing, and maintainable delivery.

SELECTED PROJECTS

- **Self-Service Cloud Platform:** Implemented a self-service platform using **SRE practices, observability, incident response**, Terraform modules, Kubernetes templates, secrets management, CI/CD workflows, observability dashboards, and cost controls.
- **Reliability and Release Automation:** Standardized deployment pipelines, SLO dashboards, incident runbooks, rollback automation, and environment checks for safer production operations.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate**
- **HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate**
- **Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD)**
- **Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate**

EDUCATION

Texas A&M University-San Antonio - Bachelor's Degree, **Computer Science** (2009 - 2013)